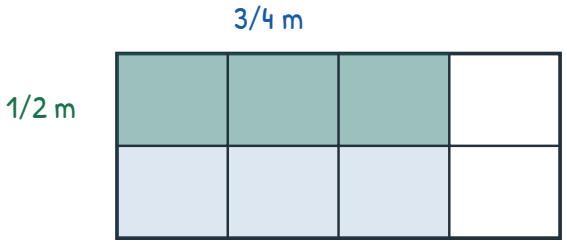
Fractional side lengths create fractional area

I can… use area to explain a fraction product.

A rectangle is 3/4 meter wide and 1/2 meter tall.



3 of 8 equal parts = 3/8 m²

split a 1 m by 1 m whole into fourths across and halves down. The green rectangle covers 3 of the 8 equal parts.

$3/4 \times 1/2 = 3/8$ m²

The product counts square meters, not meters. A half of the strip is smaller than the whole strip.